

WEALTH

A country's wealth is often measured in terms of the money it earns in a year divided by its number of inhabitants. This is called its Gross Domestic Product (GDP) per capita. Both Norway and Qatar make lots of money from exporting oil and gas, and since they have small populations their GDP per capita are very high. Burundi in east Africa has only one-twentyfifth of the income of Qatar divided between five times as many people, so its GDP per capita is very low.



BUSIEST AIRPORTS

Air travel has expanded enormously since the 1950s, when international air travel was a luxury enjoyed by a few wealthy people known as the "jet set." Today, flying is often the most economical way to travel, as well as the quickest. This is reflected in the vast number of passengers who pass through the world's airports as they travel for business or pleasure. The world's busiest airport is Hartsfield-Jackson International Airport in Atlanta, with more than 100 million people arriving and departing each year. The graphics below show the busiest airport in each continent, and number of passengers.



AIRBUS A380

The growth in air travel has led to the development of giant airliners such as the Airbus A380. When it entered service in 2007, this was the world's largest passenger plane, capable of carrying up to 853 people.



TRADE

Although air freight is an important element of international trade, about 90 percent of cargo by weight is transported by sea. Altogether, this adds up to around 11 billion tons of freight. Much of this is transported in containers, carried by more than 5,000 container ships. The busiest shipping routes link Europe and North America with the Middle East and Far East, with ports such as Singapore, Shanghai, Dubai, and Rotterdam handling most of the trade.

Traffic in millions of tons

